

NAVIGATOR KIDS

COSMO'S SPACE MISSION GUIDE

Official Flight Manual for Executive Function

COMMANDER NAME: _____

MISSION DATE: _____

WARNING: For kids with big dreams and frozen engines!

The Story of Cosmo

Meet Cosmo.

Cosmo is a Space Pup with a very big dream. He wants to fly his rocket all the way to the Moon to bury his favorite bone.

Cosmo is smart. He knows how to fly. He has a cool helmet.

But when he looks at his giant Rocket, something happens. His paws get heavy. His tummy feels tight. His brain goes blank.

*It's called **ENGINE FREEZE**.*

The mission feels too big! He doesn't know where to start, so he just sits on the launchpad and whines.

YOUR TURN:

Draw a picture of a 'Giant Task' (like cleaning a messy room or homework) that makes your engine freeze.

Mission: Launch the Rocket!

Cosmo is stuck on the launchpad. He needs a Mission Commander (YOU) to help him start his engine.

STEP 1: PLAY THE GAME

*Open 'Cosmo's Space Mission' on the computer.
Help him fuel up, check systems, and BLAST OFF.*

Did you launch?

☐ YES! I cleared the launchpad!

☐ YES! We are in orbit!

Now, let's use the Launch Sequence for YOUR life.

TOOL 1: THE COUNTDOWN

When a task is big, we don't do it all at once. We do a Countdown (5-4-3-2-1).

THE MISSION: Pick one big thing (like 'Clean Room').

5. Pick up TRASH	☐ Check
4. Pick up CLOTHES	☐ Check
3. Pick up TOYS	☐ Check
2. Make BED	☐ Check
1. BLAST OFF! (Done)	☐ Check

We don't do 'The Room.' We just do 'Step 5.'

TOOL 2: ROCKET FUEL

Rockets can't fly empty. They need fuel! Your brain needs 'Dopamine' to get started.

WHAT IS YOUR FUEL?

Circle the things that help you get moving:

☐ Fast Music	☐ Crunchy Snack
☒ A Timer	☐ A Partner

MY FUEL RECIPE:

Before I start a hard job, I will...

TOOL 3: MISSION CONTROL

Astronauts never fly alone. They talk to Mission Control.

If you are stuck (Engine Freeze), use your radio.

1. *'Houston, I have a problem.'*

2. *'I don't know where to start.'*

3. *'Can you sit with me while I launch?'*

Who is your Mission Control? (Mom? Dad? Teacher?)

MISSION CONTROL MANUAL

The Science of Task Initiation

1. Executive Dysfunction (Engine Freeze)

It's not laziness. It's a disconnect between 'knowing' what to do and 'doing' it. The brain is overwhelmed by the size of the task.

2. Task Chunking (The Countdown)

Working memory can only hold 3-4 items. Breaking a task into micro-steps reduces cognitive load and makes 'starting' possible.

3. Body Doubling (Mission Control)

Simply having another person present acts as an external nervous system, providing the regulation needed to initiate a task.

4. Dopamine Bridging (Rocket Fuel)

ADHD brains need stimulation to engage. Using music or snacks isn't a distraction; it's the fuel that turns the engine on.

COMMANDER'S POCKET KIT

Instructions: Cut these out and keep them in your pocket.

■ LAUNCH SEQUENCE

1. Break it down.
2. Find the FIRST step.
3. 5-4-3-2-1... GO!

■ RADIO CHECK

Stuck? Radio for help:

'Houston, I have a problem.'
'Where do I start?'

OFFICIAL MISSION COMMANDER

This certifies that

**Has learned to Launch Rockets
and conquer Engine Freeze!**

"TO INFINITY AND BEYOND!"